CHITY GROUP

Imagery

Photography and image direction

1. Role of imagery

Imagery gives CHITY GROUP human scale and evidence. It shows progress, people and substance rather than decoration, and it keeps the parent brand sector-neutral. Images support the message; they never carry a sector, a subsidiary or a claim the group cannot prove.

2. Image families

Four families make up the imagery. Each answers a different part of the brand story.

FAMILY	SHOWS	DIRECTION
Structures	Architecture, glass, infrastructure and city detail.	Use sparingly so the group does not read as property or construction. Prefer detail and perspective to full skylines. Avoid recognizable third-party buildings and signage.
People	Real people at work and in partnership.	Candid, natural and diverse. Show competence and collaboration. No staged poses, forced handshakes or thumbs-up groups.
Nature and detail	Leaves, water, materials, light and macro texture.	Supports responsible growth and long-term thinking. Natural light and shallow depth of field.
Motion and abstract	Light trails, movement, and the brand curve set over calm imagery.	For banners and backgrounds. Keep it calm and uncluttered.

3. Style

ELEMENT	DIRECTION
Lighting	Natural and clean. Soft daylight, dusk and dawn. Avoid harsh flash and heavy artificial color.
Color	Cool and navy-leaning in the shadows, with natural, accurate skin tones. Never tint people blue.
Contrast	Moderate. No heavy filters, vignettes, high-dynamic-range effects or color overlays.
Composition	A clear subject and a calm area where text can sit. Generous space around the subject.
Cropping	Crop for the format: 16:9 for presentations and the web, 1:1 and 4:5 for social media, portrait for covers.
Authenticity	Real places and real people from the group's context where possible.

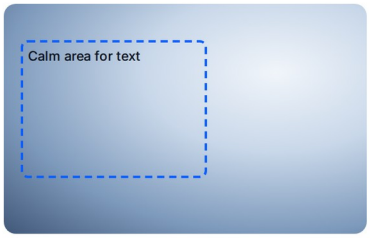
4. Building a set

- Any set of four or more images draws on at least two families, and no family exceeds half of the set.
- No single sector or operating business becomes the face of the parent brand.
- Each layout has one dominant image. Support it with calm detail or white space.
- Choose images that could sit equally well in any sector the group enters.

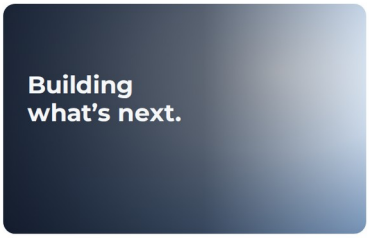
5. Sourcing and files

ITEM	REQUIREMENT
Rights	Use only commissioned photography or images licensed for commercial use. Keep the license and usage terms with the file.
Releases	Obtain model releases for identifiable people and property releases for private locations.
Resolution	At least 3000 px on the long edge for web heroes and covers; 300 dpi at final size for print.
Format	JPG or WebP for photography (quality 80 to 85). sRGB color profile.
Names	CHITYGROUP_Image_[Family]_[Subject]_[Orientation]_[Number].jpg
Accessibility	Every image placed online has descriptive alternative text. No essential text is embedded in an image.

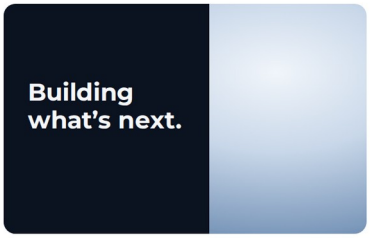
6. Text and logos over images



1 Choose a calm area
Pick or crop images so a quiet area is left for any text.



2 Gradient overlay
Deep Navy, at least 60% where text sits, fading to 0%.



3 Solid panel
Use when the image is busy or the area cannot be kept calm.

The panels above are illustrations, not photographs.

METHOD	RULE
Calm area	Choose or crop the image so a quiet area remains for text.
Gradient overlay	Deep Navy at 60% or more where text sits, fading to 0%. At 60% over a pure white image, Cloud White text still reaches 4.6:1; at 70% it reaches 6.6:1.
Solid panel	Use a solid Deep Navy panel when the image is busy or the area cannot be kept calm.
Headlines	Montserrat Bold, at most two lines, Cloud White on the overlay or panel.
Logo	Use the one-color White or Navy logo on imagery, on a calm area. Never place the full-color logo on an image.

7. Commissioning brief

Give this checklist to any photographer or image supplier.

1. **Subject:** people at work, built environments, natural detail or abstract light, as agreed for the shoot.
2. **Mood:** confident, calm, human. Progress and substance, not spectacle.
3. **Light and color:** natural light, cool shadows, accurate skin tones.
4. **Composition:** a clear subject with a calm area on one side for text. Supply both horizontal and vertical crops.
5. **People:** candid and unposed, in real working situations.
6. **Avoid:** clichés (handshakes, globes, stock office scenes), heavy filters, branded third-party products, and the visible logos of other companies.
7. **Deliverables:** high-resolution originals with releases, usage terms and captions.